Cisco Security Research

Analyst Console Guide

Talos' New RulesUI

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Analyst Console

Welcome to Analyst Console. It is an application to be used by analysts to write rules, keep track of bugs, and allows analysts to fix rules related to Snort. Analyst Console helps analysts keep track of changes to rules and keep track of rules that are bugged so that they can fix them. Analyst Console is the RulesUI where you can interact with bugs from Bugzilla.

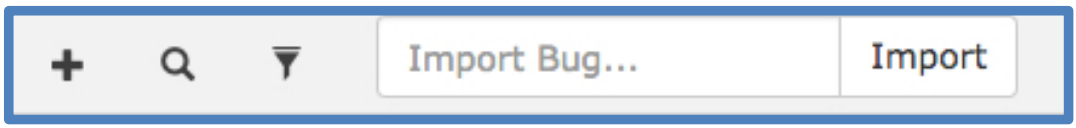
Accessing Analyst Console

To access Analyst Console, you will go to https://rulesuitest.vrt.sourcefire.com/ in either Chrome or Safari (IE is not supported). You will be automatically signed in if you have run KINIT on your machine that day. If not, you will be required to log in using your Talos credentials.

The navigation panel under the hamburger icon:

Navigating the Bug List Dashboard

This is the navigation bar in the 'BUG LIST' Dashboard of Analyst Console:



View Just Your Bugs

The default view of the 'BUG LIST' is just your bugs. To access your bug list, you will click on the hamburger in the upper left corner and select 'BUG LIST' on the left menu. Your bug list by clicking on your name in the upper right corner of the homepage and viewing your open bugs in your profile page assignment queue.

Create a New Bug

The plus sign button in the navigation bar is to create new bug in Analyst Console. Bug information is communicated back to Bugzilla and vice versa so bug information entered in Analyst Console will appear in Bugzilla.

Search in Analyst Console

The magnifying glass in the navigation bar is the search feature for Analyst Console. You can use this button to search for a bug, user, committer, or search for bugs in a certain state in Analyst Console. Here you will enter your search criteria and Analyst Console will pull information accordingly.

Filter Bugs in Analyst Console

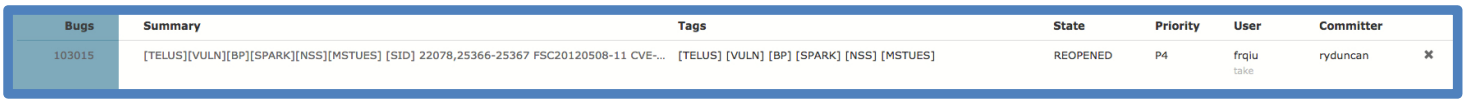
The funnel button in the navigation bar is the filter feature. You can use the filter to view just your bugs, your team's bugs, open bugs, pending bugs, or all of the bugs in Analyst Console. This is, in essence, a pre-made quick search feature for you to filter bugs you may need to view quickly.

Import Bugs into Analyst Console

The 'Import Bug…' text box and 'Import' button is where you can import bugs from Bugzilla into Analyst Console. Most new bugs should have already been imported into Analyst Console, but this feature allows you to import bugs that may not currently be in Analyst Console. Importing bugs from Bugzilla does not remove bugs from Bugzilla and any changes made to bugs in Analyst Console are communicated back to Bugzilla.

Remove Bugs from Analyst Console

The 'x' on the right hand side of the 'BUG LIST' dashboard will remove the bug from Analyst Console. This *does not* remove the bug from Bugzilla, just from Analyst Console.



Bugs	Summary	Tags	State	Priority	User	Committer	
103015	[TELUS][VULN][BP][SPARK][NSS][MSTUES] [SID] 22078,25366-25367 FSC20120508-11 CVE-...	[TELUS] [VULN] [BP] [SPARK] [NSS] [MSTUES]	REOPENED	P4	frqiu take	ryduncan	✖

Working on a Bug in Analyst Console

Once you have selected a bug to work on, the panel for the individual bug will look similar to the following:

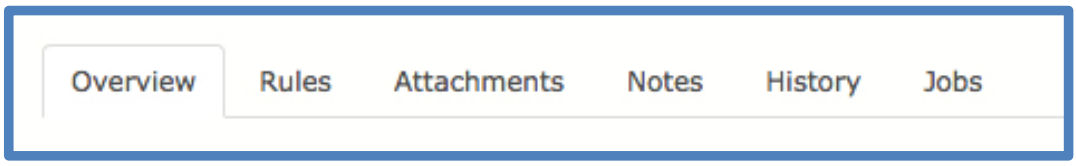
The Bug State

The top of the dashboard once you have selected a bug will have the Bugzilla ID number. There is a small chain link icon next to the ID number that will take you directly to the bug in Bugzilla if you click on it. The **state** of the bug, **priority**, **component**, **editor**, and **committer** are all next. All these sections operate in the same capacity and can be changed via the change button next to each section if you need to make updates to them.

The summary section for the bug is directly below the ID and state section and shows up the same as it would in Bugzilla. You can change the summary via the change button next to the section as well.

The Bug Details

To view bug details after you have selected the bug, you will navigate using the bug navigation bar.



Overview

The **'Overview'** tab is where the **'Tags'** section exists, the **'Tags'** line will dynamically change the summary based on the tags that you use in Analyst Console and add them to the Summary so you do not need to manually add them. This section also has the **'References'** section is brought in when you import the bug from Bugzilla. The references will link to the outside documentation when imported from Bugzilla. The **'Exploits'** section will list any known exploits related to that bug. The **'Metrics'** section will display any pertinent metrics to the bug such as how long it was open, etc.

Rules

The **'Rules'** tab is where you would interact with the bug and the rules themselves. Here, you can you select rules to view the rule(s) you have selected and Analyst Console will display them in this tab. If a rule has been changed, the old line will be highlighted in red with the specific change(s) highlighted in a lighter color after you click on the version column or use the "View" button. The new is in green and the new line of the rule directly below.

List All Button

The "list all" button shows you all the rules associated with that bug.

Edit Button

The “edit” button allows you to select the rule(s) to edit by checking the box(es) and clicking the “edit” button. Here you can change your rule(s) in the ‘Rule Content’ section. There are built in ‘Documentation’ boxes so you can add your summary, impact, etc. to the rule directly related to the rule and/or the changes you made. You must click ‘Save Changes’ button at the bottom for each bug (if there is more than one bug opened to edit, you must click the ‘Save Changes’ button under each rule respectively for the changes to be saved).

Revert Button

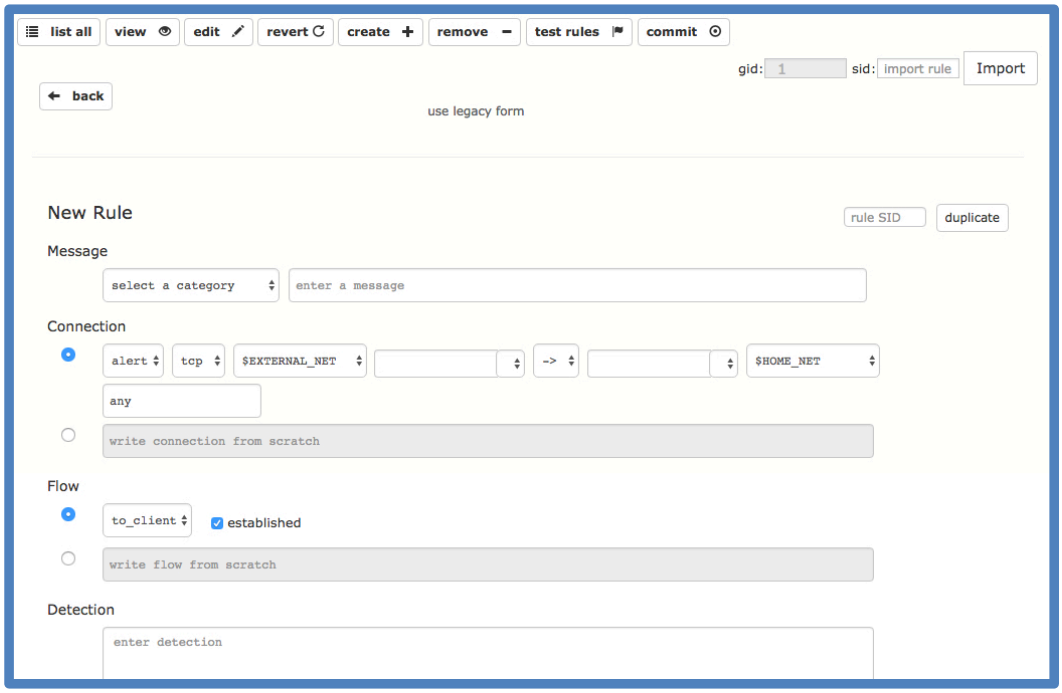
The “revert” button allows you to revert the rule(s) you selected to the SVN file if you want to revert back to the prior state of the rule by selecting the rule(s) and clicking the “revert” button. The “revert” button can also be used to update a rule if SVN had been updated. The “revert” button can also revert a rule if you started an edit, but cannot commit because SVN has been updated.

Create Button

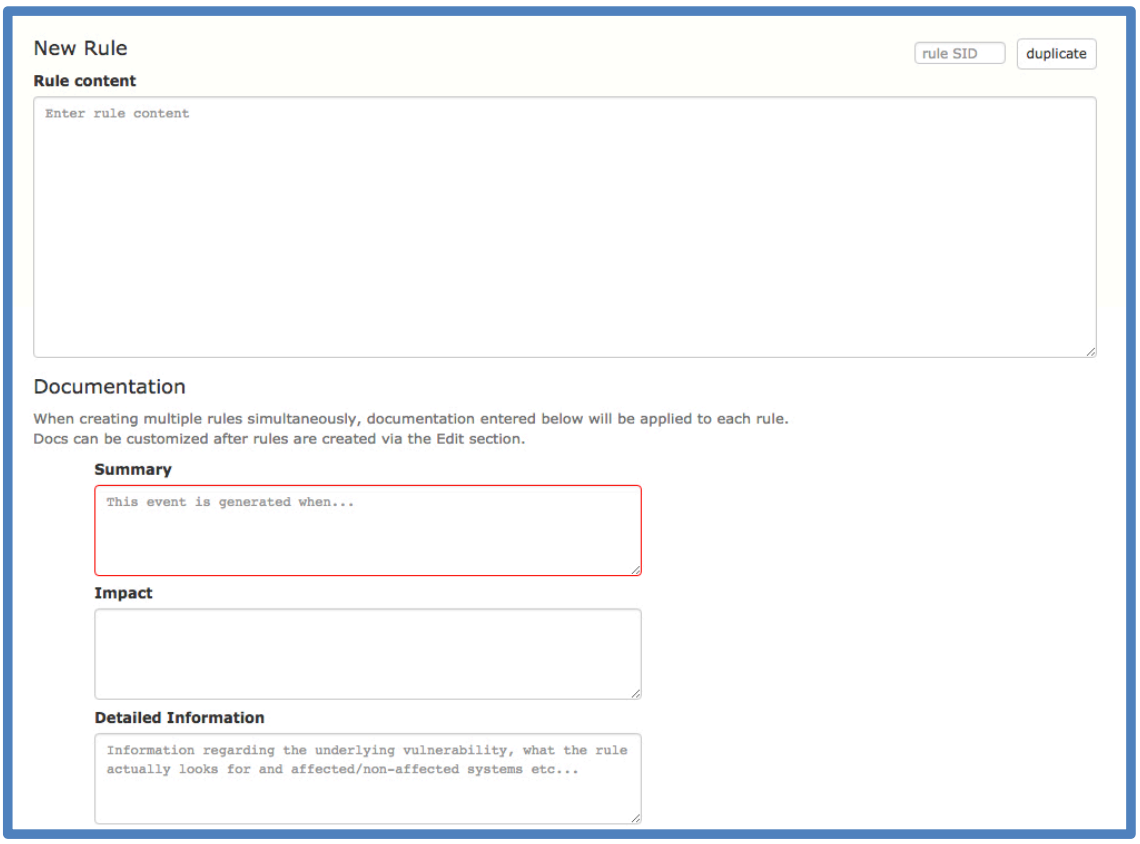
The “create” button allows you to create a new rule. You can write your new rule in the ‘Rule Content’ area. You must add a ‘Summary’ in the Documentation section when creating a new rule otherwise it will not allow you to save the new rule.

You will click the “Create Rule” button at the bottom of the page to add the new rule to the bug. You can write a new rule using either the legacy form or the standard form, shown below. You can change between the two forms by selecting either” use standard form” or “use legacy form” depending on which form you are currently on.

New rule using the standard form:



New rule using the legacy form:



Remove Button

The “remove” button allows you to remove a rule in Analyst Console. When a rule is removed from Analyst Console, it does not remove the rule from SVN, just Analyst Console.

Test Rules Button

The “test rules” button allows you to test rules in Analyst Console against the pcaps (attachments). You select the rule(s) you want to test and click the ‘test rules’ button. After you selected the rules and clicked ‘test rules’ you will receive a message in red at the top of the rules table. If the test creation is successful you will see “Task has been created” and if the test creation is unsuccessfully created, it will say “Task has not been created.” The aforementioned task alert is just an alert that the job has been created and is queued for processing.

When the test is finished, it will return an ‘Alert’ in the rule line for however many alerts are related to the rule test completed. Clicking that number of the alert will expand and show you the list of attachments that alerted or did not alert. A test will appear in the ‘Jobs’ tab when created. The guide will cover that tab later in the document.

Commit Button

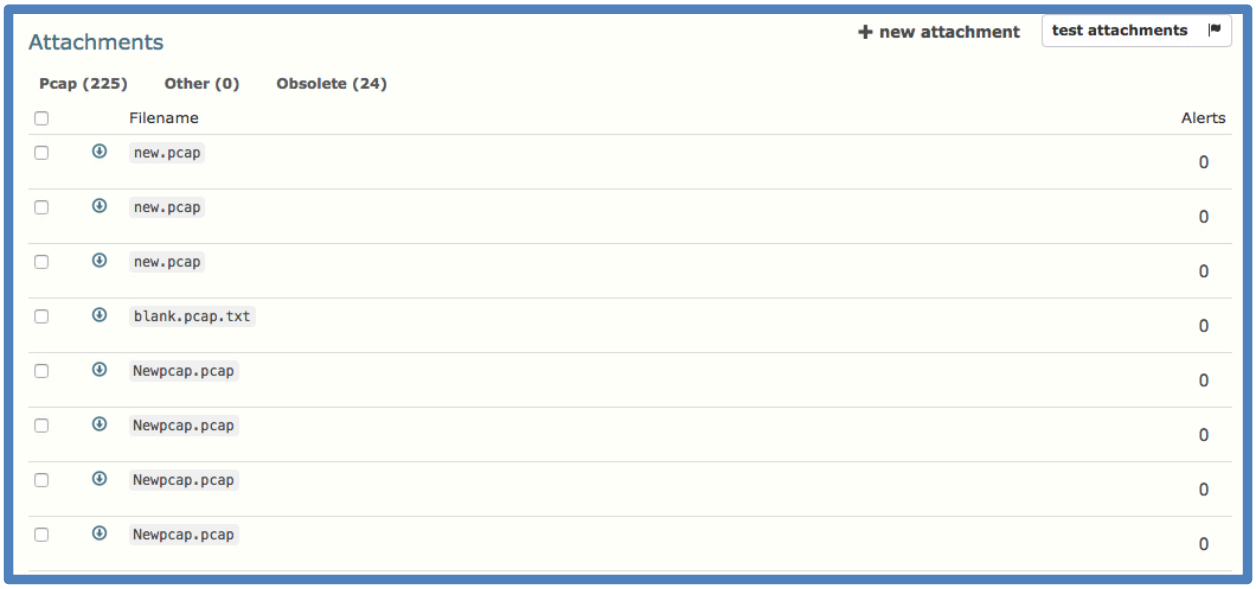
The “commit” button allows you to commit rules by checking the rule you want to commit and clicking the ‘commit’ button. To commit a rule, your account must have committing privileges by having the role “committer” assigned to you by your manager. You will confirm you want to commit the rules in the pop up window. Once confirmed, the rules will be sent to SVN. The manager of the team can add privileges to the people on the team.

Import

You can import rules that you know are in the system, but may not be in Analyst Console by typing the rule sid into the 'sid' box and clicking import. This way you can apply existing rules to the bug.

Attachments

The 'Attachments' tab lists all the attachments for that bug that Bugzilla knows about.



You can upload attachments to Bugzilla and they will be displayed in Analyst Console and vice versa. You can download any of the attachments in Analyst Console by clicking the down arrow button to the left of the file name.

To mark a file as obsolete, you need to go to Bugzilla to mark the file as obsolete.

To test attachments, you must select the attachments you want to test and then click the 'test attachments' button. This will test all the selected attachments against all the rules in SVN. If attachments alert against a rule in SVN, the alert will come up in the attachment table.

Notes

The 'Notes' tab contains notes made by analysts and by committers (if applicable). The narrative that a researcher provides when resolving a bug. Committer notes (if applicable) can be added by a committer to communicate to the analyst in a more informal way. Once both of these types of notes are saved, they are not committed to Bugzilla yet. To publish to Bugzilla, you will click the 'publish' button after you save the note(s).

History

The 'History' tab shows the user the history of all the notes from Analyst Console and from Bugzilla. In the 'History' you can also add comments, that are not considered notes, into the history of the bug. The comments will show up in Analyst Console history and also in Bugzilla history.

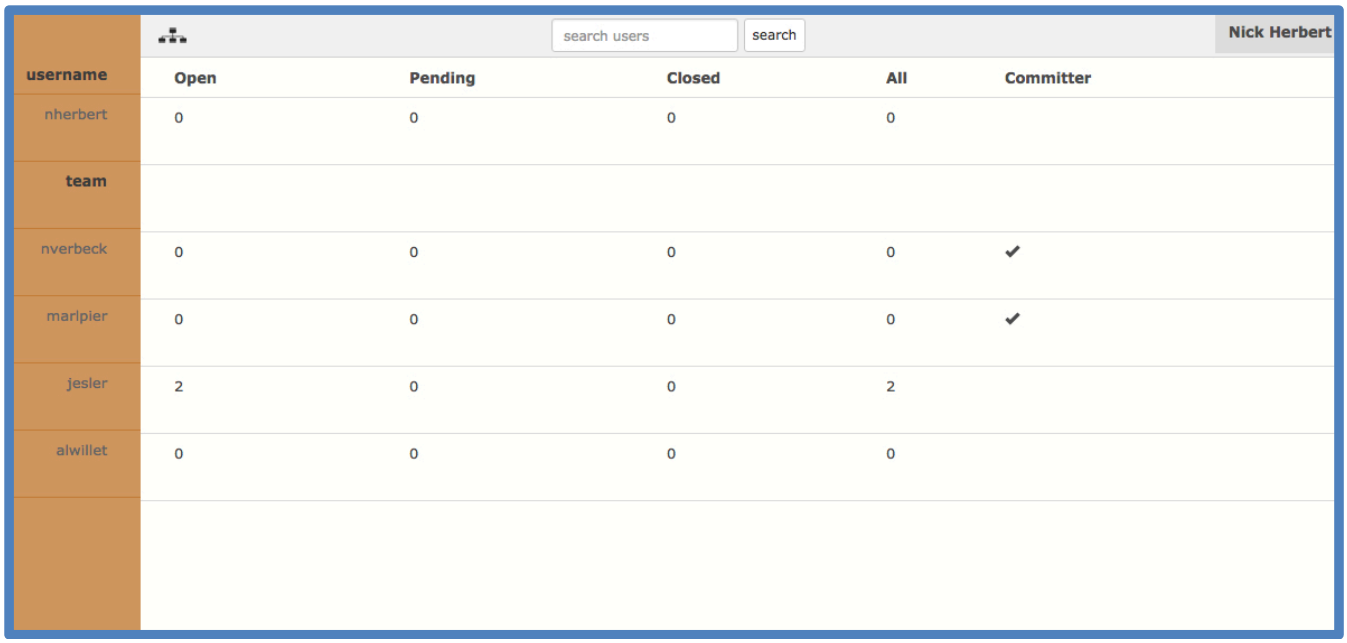
Tasks or Jobs

The 'Tasks or Jobs' tab is a table of tasks that have been enacted on the specific bug. The tasks or jobs will show with unchecked boxes for 'Completed' and 'Failed' if the job is still in process. If a job fails, you will see a blue check in the 'Complete' box and a blue check in the Failed box as well. If a job is completed and passes, just the 'Completed' box will be checked. Sometimes the test will yield a result and that will appear in the Result area. If a task is completed and nothing is in the results area, it means the rules API did not produce a visible result.

Users Tab

Under the 'USERS' tab it shows you your user metrics, privileges, team, and co-workers. You can also view your bugs in this view. A manager can add people to their team from the chart image in the upper left corner, add managers below them and their reports, as well as see the metrics for all the members of their team.

The default view of the 'USERS' tab, will default to show your metrics and the metrics for your team:

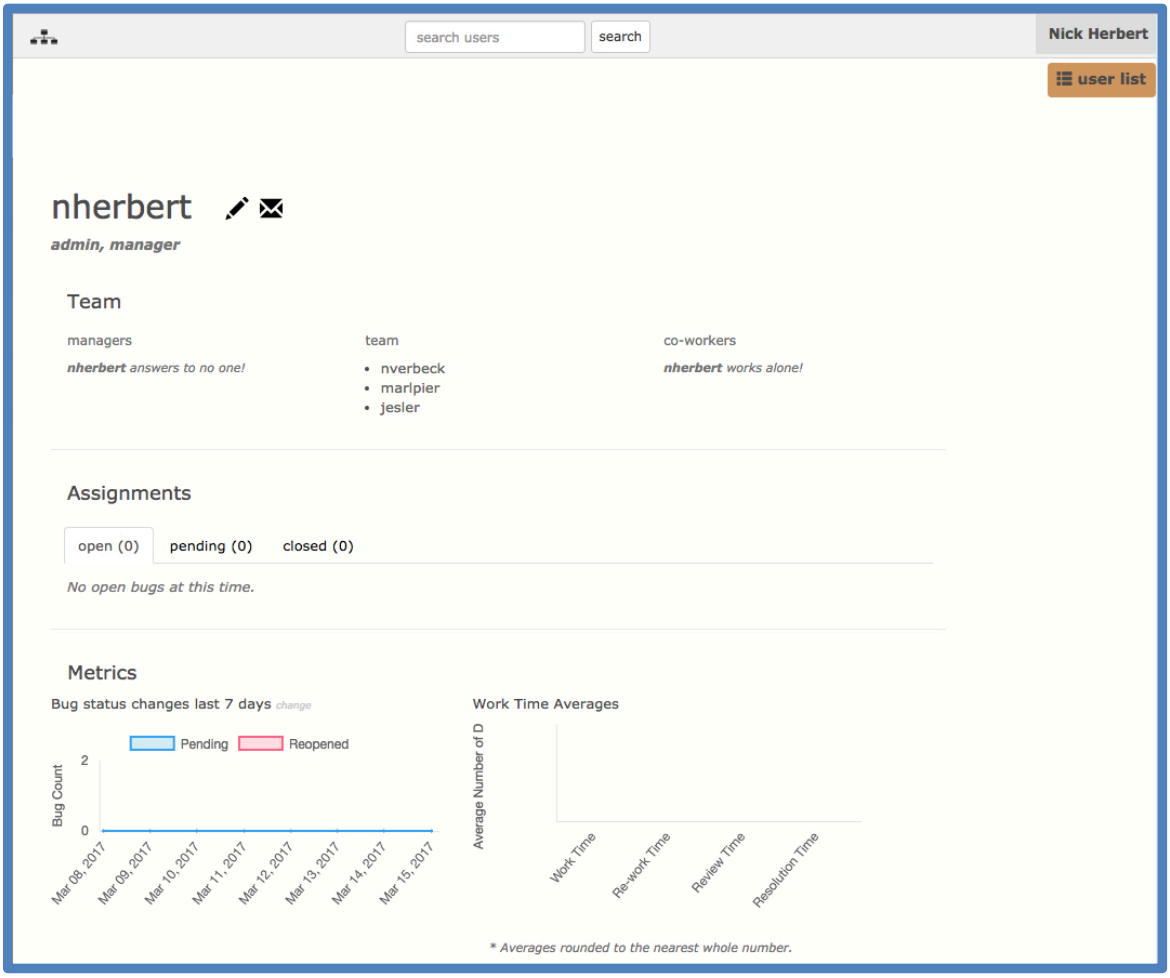


username	Open	Pending	Closed	All	Committer
nherbert	0	0	0	0	
team					
nverbeck	0	0	0	0	✔
marlpier	0	0	0	0	✔
jesler	2	0	0	2	
alwillet	0	0	0	0	

Individual User Page

You can select the username of yourself or teammates to see a more detailed page.

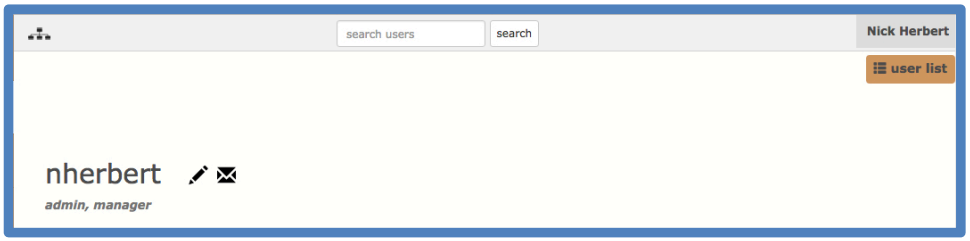
Individual pages look similar to the following:



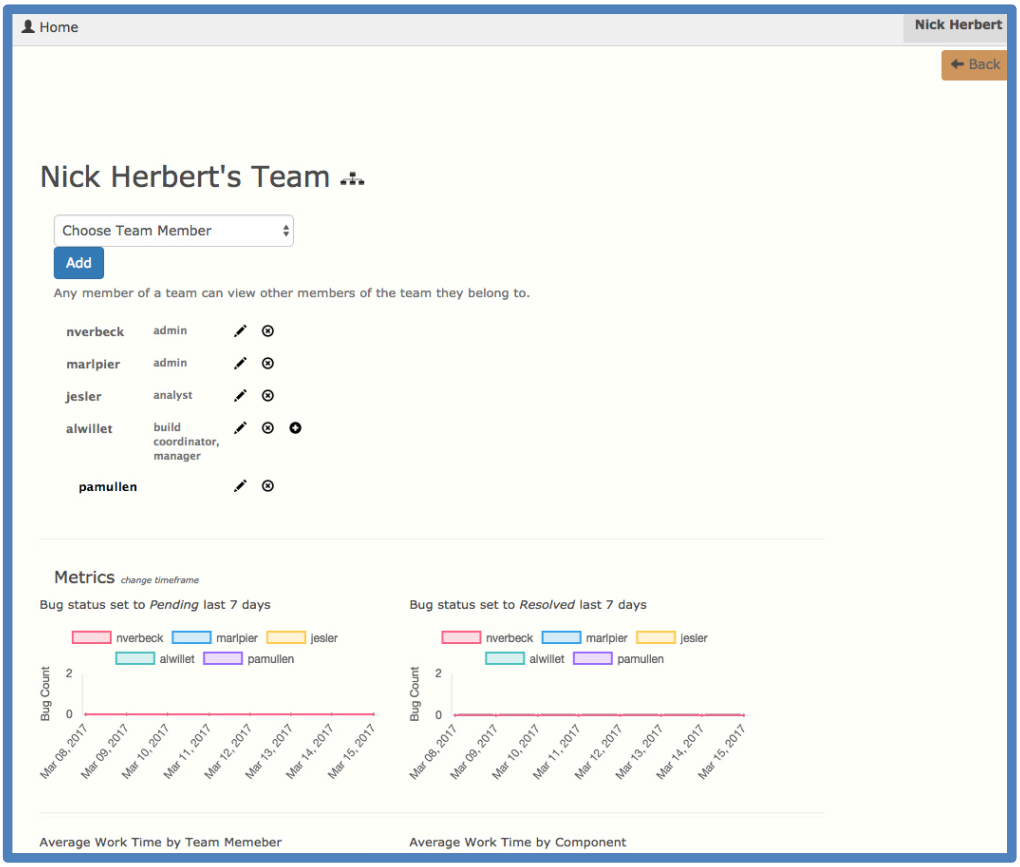
You can see your individual assignments, team members, and metrics for assignments on this page. You can change the time frame of metrics for both the 'Metrics' on your page as well as any of your reports pages to show activities during different time periods.

Managers User Page

Managers can select the “Flow Chart’ image in the upper left corner to view their team page.



The manager’s team page will look like this:



Managers can only make team members “Managers” by clicking on the pencil icon next to the team member’s name. Managers can also assign ‘grandfather’ team members to managers within their team (so if the managers direct report has direct reports, they can add them thusly).

They can add or remove members from below them in the hierarchy by selecting new members from the drop down and clicking add or remove them clicking the ‘x’ button to the right of the member’s name.

Managers can also see metrics for members of their team in the Metric’s area at the bottom portion of the page and change the time period for the metrics as detailed above.